

The Wellerman

For SATB* a cappella

Duration: ca. 2:15

Arranged by
ROGER EMERSON

New Zealand Folksong

With a bawdy bounce (♩ = ca. 96)

Solo, Section or All voices throughout

 m_f

Bass

There once was a ship that put to sea, the

3

name of the ship was the Bil - ly of Tea; the winds blew up, her

6

bow dipped down O blow, my bul - ly boys, blow.

9

Soprano

mf

Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

Alto *mf*

Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

Tenor *mf*

Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

Bass

Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

***Available separately: TTBB (00368390), SATB (00368391), SAB (00368392), 2-Part (00368393), TBB (00368394), SSA (00368395)**

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tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

8 tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

12 tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

take our leave and go.

take our leave and go.

8 take our leave and go.

15 take our leave and go. She had not been two

18 weeks from shore when down on her a right whale bore; the

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

21 cap - tain called all hands and swore he'd take that whale in

24 tow. *Huh!* Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to

25 *Huh!* Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to

27 bring us su - gar and tea and rum. One day, when the

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and go.

tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and go.

tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and go.

30 tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and go. Be -

33

fore the boat had hit the wa - ter the whale's... tail came

up and caught her; all hands to the side, har - pooned and fought her when

36

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

41

Huh! Soon may the

39 she dived down be - low. *Huh!* Soon may the

Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and tea and rum.

42 Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and tea and rum.

One day, when the tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

45 One day, when the tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

49

go. go. go. go.

No line was cut, no whale was freed, the
for - ty days or e - ven more, the

cap - tain's mind was then not tight on greed; but he be - longed to the
line went slack then tight once more; all boats were lost, there were

whale - man's creed, she took that ship in tow. } Huh!
on - ly four, but still that whale did go. } Huh!

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

57 *f*

Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

8 *f*

Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

57 Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and

tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

8 tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

60 tea and rum. One day, when the tongu-in' is done we'll

1 2

take our leave and go. go.

take our leave and go. go.

8 take our leave and go. go.

63 take our leave and go. For go. As

ff

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

66

66 far as I've heard, the fight's still on, the line's not cut and the

69 whale's not gone; the Wel-ler-man makes his reg-u-lar call to en -

74

72 cour-age the cap-tain, crew and all. Soon may the

74 *ff* Soon may the

74 *ff* Soon may the

74 *ff* Soon may the

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and tea and rum.

Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and tea and rum.

Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and tea and rum.

75 Wel - ler - man come to bring us su - gar and tea and rum.

One day, when the tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

One day, when the tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

One day, when the tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

78 One day, when the tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

go. *Huh!* Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to

go. *Huh!* Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to

go. *Huh!* Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to

81 go. *Huh!* Soon may the Wel - ler - man come to

82

THE WELLERMAN – SATB

bring us su - gar and tea and rum. One day, when the

bring us su - gar and tea and rum. One day, when the

bring us su - gar and tea and rum. One day, when the

84 bring us su - gar and tea and rum. One day, when the

tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

87 tongu - in' is done we'll take our leave and

div.
go! _____ *Huh!*

go! _____ Take our leave and go! *Huh!*

8 go! _____ *Huh!*

90 go! _____ Take our leave and go! *Huh!*

THE WELLERMAN – SATB



A “Wellerman” was an employee of the Sydney-based Weller Brothers’ shipping company, which from 1833 was the major supplier of provisions – such as the “sugar and tea and rum” of the shanty’s refrain – to whaling stations on New Zealand shores.

The whaler’s wistful eye on a future date “when the tonguin’ is done we’ll take our leave and go” refers to the practice of stripping blubber from beached whales.

Elle Hunt - The Guardian